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Graduate Recruitment Team

Cambridge Econometrics

Covent Garden

Cambridge CB1 2HT

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Training Programme in Cambridge. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Cambridge Econometrics' E3ME model, used to assess the trade-offs of decarbonisation pathways across regions and sectors, is the most ambitious applied econometrics I have seen used in consulting.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether governments that hedge oil for their economies change how their currencies react to OPEC news, by breaking it into three testable predictions for Norway, Russia and Mexico and testing each with event studies and difference-in-differences. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

Cambridge Econometrics stands out to me because its graduate training programme places new economists in its Society or Environment teams, where models such as E3ME turn energy and climate policy questions into evidence for clients. My dissertation's event studies and difference-in-differences, and my CAPM study, have given me practical experience of building, testing and explaining econometric models, and I would like to develop those skills on energy and environment projects.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan